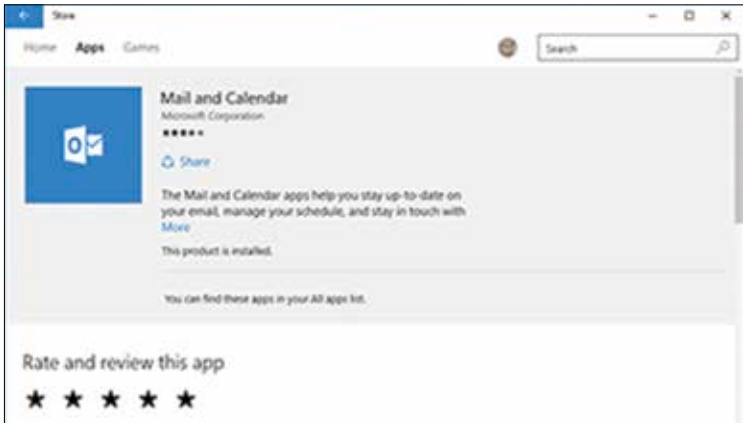




The basic apps that ship with Windows 10 can be installed and updated from the Windows Store.

With Windows 10, Microsoft no longer differentiates between updates that fix the OS and those that add new features (and possibly new bugs). In Windows 8 we saw some of this in the form of apps that Microsoft shipped with the OS getting updated with new features through the Windows store separate from the OS. Now the entire OS will work the same way.

Microsoft will keep releasing updates to its core apps through the Windows 10 store, and will keep updating the core Windows 10 experience through new builds delivered via Windows Update.

People were understandably confused when Microsoft made a Windows upgrade free, and then started talking of Windows-as-a-Service and of constant new upgrades. The first thought everyone had was that after the first free year of the upgrade, Microsoft would start charging for upgrades. This notion was probably a fundamental misunderstanding of what Microsoft is trying to accomplish brought on by their own poor communication.

To clarify then, when you buy Windows 10, or upgrade to it for free from Windows 7, 8 or 8.1 you get a license to Windows 10 that includes all upgrades to the OS for free. It is a service, but the kind that has a one-time payment that is included in the price of the device you purchase, or the retail license for Windows 10 that you purchase.

Perhaps what is more interesting today is not that the Windows 10 upgrade is free, and that it is the last version of Windows, or that it now uses a Software-as-a-Service model, but that all of these things make sense (to an extent) given the ecosystem of devices today.